

a connect with potential clients looking to hire somebody for similar work. Do not forget to add images from your personal portfolio instead of using stock images taken off the internet.

Creating your niche

Let's look at a hypothetical situation here. You have been a freelance product designer for a year now. While you have a portfolio of work that has been done across various segments, more than a few of your clients were related to the beauty and cosmetics industry. Perhaps you could consider this as your niche and try to make a mark in the said industry.

How do you go about doing this, you ask? You could start with joining Facebook groups that are related to the industry, especially the kind where you will find relevant people from the business rather than end customers. Try to help people with queries related to product design. Probably explain why the design of their favorite liquid liner helps them get that perfect 'wing eyed' look. Get them to look beyond just branding, and understand why your services are of the utmost importance to a brand creating utilitarian designs that also look 'world class'.

Connect with magazines and online publications that cater to your niche and offer to write articles for them. Once you start getting the word out there, you will establish yourself as a voice to be heard and a name to be reckoned with. More business owners from this segment will see your work and will be more likely to hire you for your services than hire a competitor whose name they have never even heard.

Work hard, play hard

Who said you can't get work done with a glass of wine in your hand? It's probably the best way to get any work done (just saying!). Networking events that allow you to meet people from your industry or sometimes even other industries might be exactly what you need to land new work.

When you work in the online sector, it is very easy to think of all your advertising needs as being served by the online marketplace. It's probably as far from the truth as you will ever be. Nothing can ever beat the concept of you 'selling yourself' to another person in a face-to-face setting. Think about it. What's the first question someone asks you when they meet you for the first ever time. 9 out of 10 people will probably start with 'So, what do you do?'. Has there ever been a better opportunity for a sales pitch about your services?